

but receiving two is an absolute honour. Receiving even one award is special, but two feel like the ultimate recognition. I'm glad to be part of this evening and to have Sportstar give me two trophies. So yeah, that's super nice," Manu later says, grinning from ear to ear while seated on a plush sofa in her suite.

It has taken fire and frost to shape Manu into the athlete she is today. At the Tokyo Olympics in 2021, an equipment malfunction, the pressures of the grandest stage, and the sport's inherent unpredictability conspired against her.

However, strengthened by the scars of that emotional battle and with a renewed hunger to reclaim her place among the elite, Manu became independent India's first athlete to win two medals (bronze in 10-metre air pistol and 10-metre air pistol mixed team) in a single edition of the Olympic Games in Paris. She also became only the second Indian female athlete to secure multiple Olympic medals after badminton ace P. V. Sindhu.



I AM GENERALLY A HAPPY, POSITIVE PERSON. BUT I DO SULK A LOT AS WELL. MY FRIENDS HELP ME COME OUT OF IT



Social media erupted in celebration, television news channels looped her podium moments endlessly, newspapers and magazines hailed the young markswoman, and sponsorship deals poured in as an entire nation swelled with pride. Yet, through all the adulation, Manu remains grounded and effervescent.

"It's not like I'm very famous or anything. Nowadays, when people recognise me, they tend to be very



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